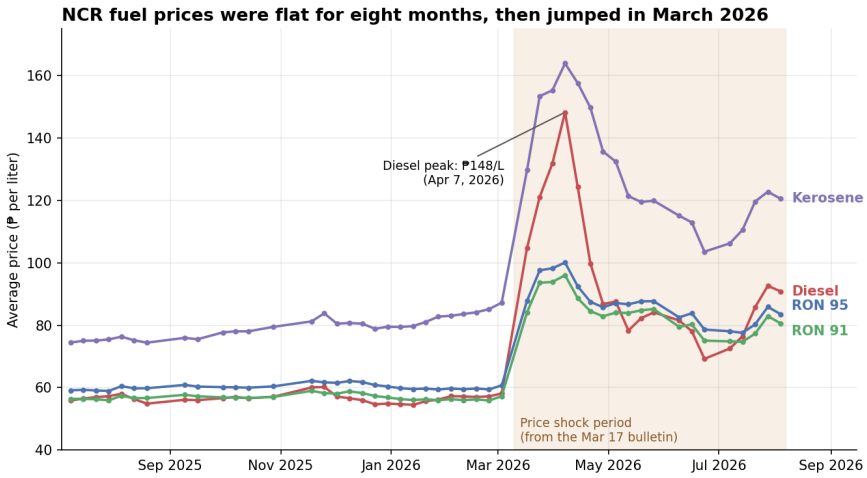
NCR fuel prices: what changed in 2026 and what it means for you

Plain-language brief for consumers and journalists | Metro Manila | Based on 48 weekly DOE price bulletins, July 8, 2025 to August 4, 2026

The Department of Energy (DOE) publishes weekly pump-price bulletins for Metro Manila. This brief turns 48 of them into one dataset to answer: **how have fuel prices changed, and how do they vary by fuel type, city and brand?**



Average of brand-reported price midpoints across 9 NCR cities. Weeks with no DOE bulletin are skipped, so lines connect across gaps.

₱148
Average diesel price per liter at the April 7, 2026 peak (₱58 on March 3)

+60%
How far diesel was still above its old price on August 4, 2026 (₱91 per liter)

₱7
Per liter that Shell averages above independent stations, same fuel, city and week

What we found

- **Prices were steady, then jumped.** From July 2025 to early March 2026, diesel stayed around ₱55 to ₱60 per liter. By the April 7, 2026 bulletin it averaged ₱148 (162% above its old level). Diesel then fell to ₱69 on June 23, but climbed back to ₱91 by August 4.
- **Diesel and kerosene were hit hardest.** At the peak, diesel was 162% above its pre-shock price and kerosene 97%; gasoline grades were 59% to 71% above. On August 4, diesel was still 60% above, kerosene 45% and gasoline 35% to 43%.
- **Who you buy from matters more than where.** City averages differ by only about -3% to +2.5% (roughly ₱1 to ₱3 per liter). Brands differ by about 6% either way, and the gap is largest on premium gasoline (RON 95 and RON 97). Brand gaps stay close to the same peso amount even when prices rise.

Why it matters

Diesel is widely used by public transport and freight, so a rise this large can reach fares and the price of goods. This brief measures pump prices only; it does not measure those knock-on effects. Because prices can swing by double digits in a week (diesel rose as much as 16% in one week and fell as much as 20% in another), the exact week you fill up now makes a real difference.

What you can do

1. **Consumers: compare brands the same week, especially for premium gasoline.** On average Shell is about ₱5 per liter above independent stations on diesel and RON 91, and about ₱12 above on RON 95. Do not drive to another city to save: city gaps are only about ₱1 to ₱3.
2. **Consumers and small fleet operators: check the latest DOE bulletin each week** while prices are volatile, instead of assuming last week's price still holds.
3. **Journalists: name the fuel and quote gaps in pesos.** "Prices doubled" is true for diesel at the peak (+162%) but overstates gasoline (+59% to +71%).

What this does not tell you. *Metro Manila only, not other regions. Nine weekly bulletins are missing, including March 10, 2026, so the first step of the jump is not visible. Figures are DOE-reported price ranges (midpoints), not individual pump prices, and independent stations are a mixed group. The data shows what changed, not why; news coverage linked the March 2026 surge to the Middle East conflict, but this analysis does not test causes.*

Source: DOE NCR Price Monitoring bulletins, processed by the Philippine Fuel Price Data Pipeline (github.com/credough/dep-data-engineering-open-track-aaron-celindro). Figures as of the August 4, 2026 bulletin. Method: notebooks/insights.ipynb and notebooks/segmentation_and_kpis.ipynb.